

ECE 3337: Signals & Systems Analysis

Lecture 13: Laplace Transform

**Reference: Chapter 3
(Section 3.6 – 3.8)**

Please turn off your gadgets now

Math Moment: Change of Variable

When rewriting a definite integral using a change of variable, it is important to also change the limits.

Example:

$$I = \int_{x=2}^{x=1} 2x \sin(x^2) dx$$

Let $u = x^2$, so $du = 2x dx$

$$I = \int_{u=4}^{u=1} \sin(u) du$$





Recap: Partial Fractions

The Laplace transform for an LTI system ends up as a ratio of polynomials in s

$$\mathbf{X}(s) = \frac{\mathbf{N}(s)}{\mathbf{D}(s)} = \frac{b_0 + b_1s + \dots + b_ms^m}{a_0 + a_1s + \dots + a_ns^n}$$
$$= C \frac{(s - z_1)(s - z_2)\dots(s - z_m)}{(s - p_1)(s - p_2)\dots(s - p_n)}$$

$m < n$: Strictly proper
 $m = n$: Proper
 $m > n$: Improper

**A PARTIAL FRACTION EXPANSION OF THIS RATIO
LEADS US TO THE INVERSE TRANSFORM**



Big/Messy Partial Fraction Expansions

When expressions get big/messy, it makes sense to use software tools



partial fraction expansion $(42s^2+78s+150)/(14s(s^2+s(51/14)+50/14))$



Extended Keyboard

Upload

Examples

Random

Assuming "s" is a variable | Use "s^2" as a unit instead

Input:

partial fractions

$$\frac{42s^2 + 78s + 150}{14s \left(s^2 + s \times \frac{51}{14} + \frac{50}{14} \right)}$$

Result:

Approximate form

☒ Step-by-step solution

$$\frac{42s^2 + 78s + 150}{14s \left(s^2 + \frac{51s}{14} + \frac{25}{7} \right)} = \frac{3}{s} - \frac{75}{14s^2 + 51s + 50}$$



Common Inverse Laplace Transforms

$$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\left[\frac{1}{(s+a)}\right] = e^{-at}u(t) \qquad \mathcal{L}^{-1}\left[\frac{1}{(s+a)^2}\right] = te^{-at}u(t)$$

$$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\left[\frac{\omega_0}{(s+a)^2 + \omega_0^2}\right] = e^{-at} \sin(\omega_0 t)u(t)$$

$$\mathcal{L}^{-1}\left[\frac{(s+a)}{(s+a)^2 + \omega_0^2}\right] = e^{-at} \cos(\omega_0 t)u(t)$$



Convolution in the Laplace Domain

$$y(t) = x(t) * h(t) = \int_{\tau=0-}^{\infty} x(\tau)h(t-\tau)d\tau$$

$$\mathcal{L}[x(t) * h(t)] = \int_{t=0-}^{\infty} \left[\int_{\tau=0-}^{\infty} x(\tau)h(t-\tau)d\tau \right] e^{-st} dt \quad \text{Fubini's Theorem}$$

We can change the order of integration
since t and τ are independent variables

$$= \int_{\tau=0-}^{\infty} x(\tau) \left[\int_{t=0-}^{\infty} \underline{h(t-\tau)e^{-st}} dt \right] d\tau$$

This part is just a time shift

Let $\mu = t - \tau$



Convolution in the Laplace Domain

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}[x(t) * h(t)] &= \int_{\tau=0-}^{\infty} x(\tau) \left[\int_{\mu=-\tau}^{\infty} h(\mu) e^{-s(\mu+\tau)} d\mu \right] d\tau \\ &= \int_{\tau=0-}^{\infty} x(\tau) e^{-s\tau} d\tau \int_{\mu=0-}^{\infty} h(\mu) e^{-s\mu} d\mu \\ &= \mathbf{X(s)H(s)}\end{aligned}$$

Due to causality of $h()$

To convolve two time-domain functions, we can compute their individual Laplace transforms and multiply them and then transform back to the time domain.

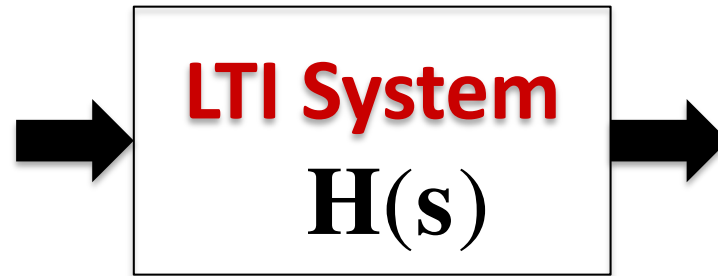


The Transfer Function

Input

$$\mathbf{X(s)}$$

$$x(t)$$



Output

$$\mathbf{Y(s) = H(s)X(s)}$$

$$y(t) = h(t) * x(t)$$

$$\mathbf{H(s) = \frac{Y(s)}{X(s)}}$$

$\mathbf{H(s)}$ is a *complete* description of an LTI system like $\mathbf{h(t)}$, and has the same information content

Its definition assumes zero initial response, i.e.,

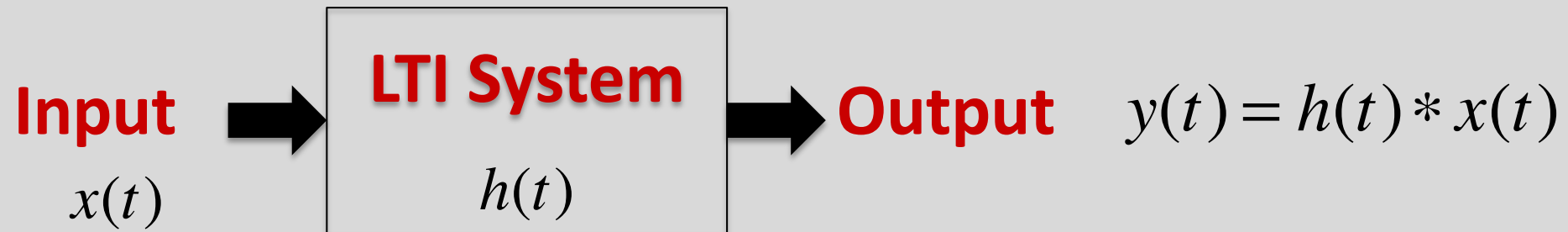
$$y(0^-) = y'(0^-) = \dots = 0$$



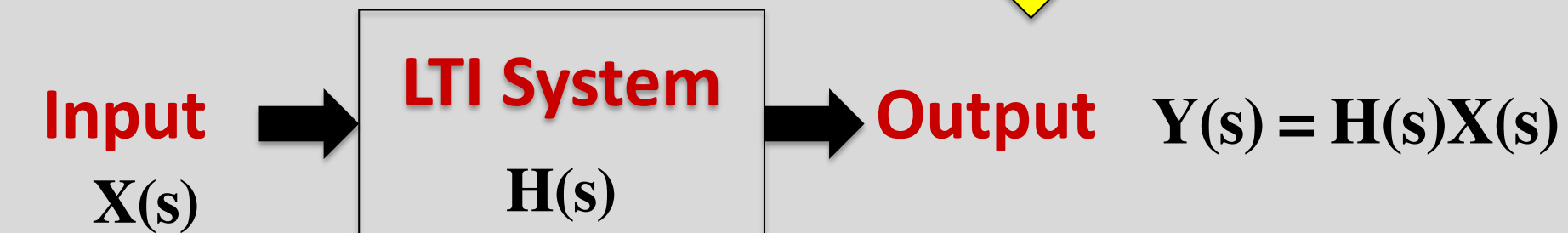
Equivalent System Pictures

We now have an alternative & equivalent way to describe an LTI system:

TIME DOMAIN



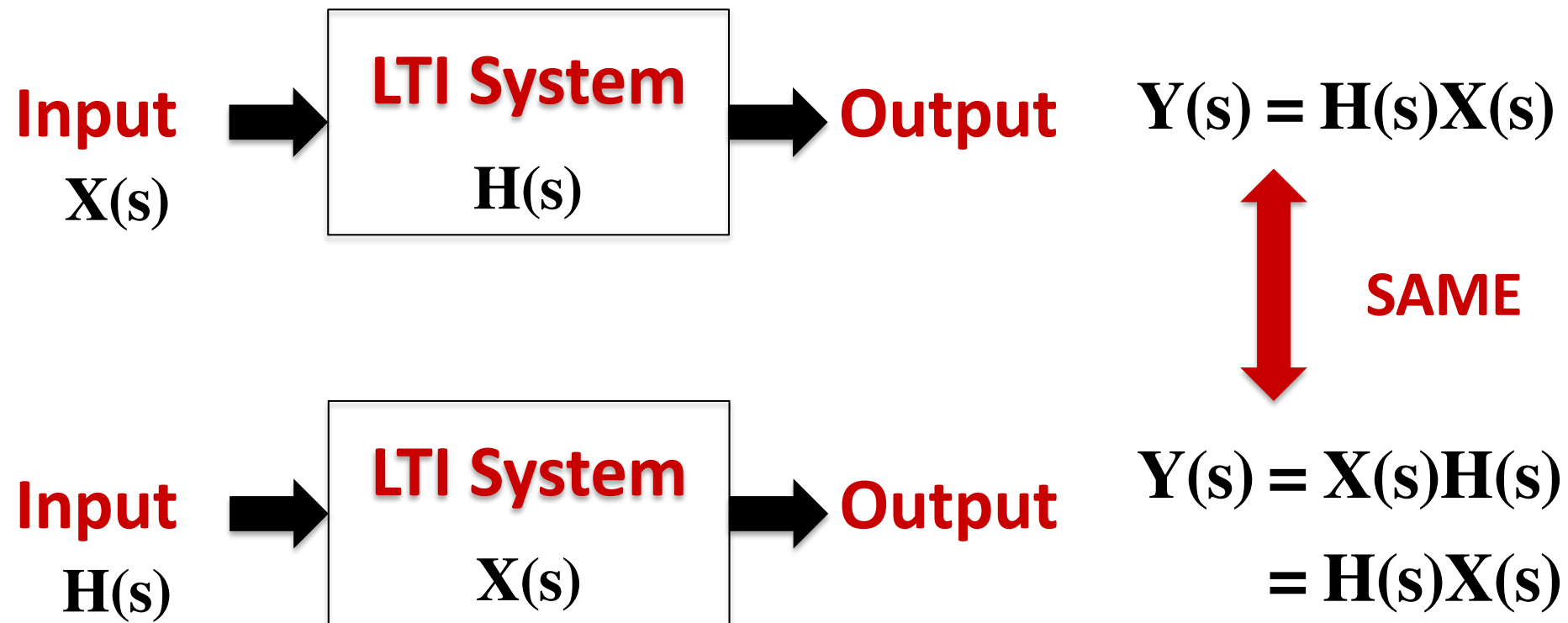
FREQUENCY DOMAIN





System or Signal?

- Signals and systems are represented in the same manner, and
- Convolution is commutative, so
 - We get the same answer if we switch the signal and the system:





Solving LCCDE's using Laplace Transforms

Redo the LCCDE using Laplace Transforms

(assume 0 initial conditions)

$$\frac{d^2 y(t)}{dt^2} + a_1 \frac{dy(t)}{dt} + a_2 y(t) = b_1 \frac{dx(t)}{dt} + b_2 x(t)$$



Amazing Power !

Let's redo the LCCDE using Laplace Transforms

$$\frac{d^2 y(t)}{dt^2} + a_1 \frac{dy(t)}{dt} + a_2 y(t) = b_1 \frac{dx(t)}{dt} + b_2 x(t)$$

$$(s^2 + a_1 s + a_2) \mathbf{Y}(s) = (b_1 s + b_2) \mathbf{X}(s)$$

$$\mathbf{H}(s) = \frac{\mathbf{Y}(s)}{\mathbf{X}(s)} = \frac{(b_1 s + b_2)}{(s^2 + a_1 s + a_2)} = \frac{(b_1 s + b_2)}{(s - p_1)(s - p_2)} = \frac{A_1}{(s - p_1)} + \frac{A_2}{(s - p_2)}$$

$$A_1 = (s - p_1) \mathbf{H}(s) \Big|_{s=p_1} = \frac{(b_1 p_1 + b_2)}{(p_1 - p_2)}$$

$$A_2 = (s - p_2) \mathbf{H}(s) \Big|_{s=p_2} = -\frac{(b_1 p_2 + b_2)}{(p_1 - p_2)}$$

$$\Rightarrow h(t) = A_1 e^{p_1 t} u(t) + A_2 e^{p_2 t} u(t)$$

WAY EASIER !!

(Adding the initial conditions is easy)



Recap: Table 2-2

Table 2-2: Commonly encountered convolutions.

1. $u(t) * u(t) = t u(t)$

2. $e^{at} u(t) * u(t) = \left(\frac{e^{at} - 1}{a} \right) u(t)$

3. $e^{at} u(t) * e^{bt} u(t) = \left[\frac{e^{at} - e^{bt}}{a - b} \right] u(t), \quad a \neq b$

4. $e^{at} u(t) * e^{at} u(t) = t e^{at} u(t)$

5. $t e^{at} u(t) * e^{bt} u(t) = \frac{e^{bt} - e^{at} + (a - b) t e^{at}}{(a - b)^2} u(t),$
 $a \neq b$

6. $t e^{at} u(t) * e^{at} u(t) = \frac{1}{2} t^2 e^{at} u(t)$

7. $\delta(t - T_1) * \delta(t - T_2) = \delta(t - T_1 - T_2)$

**LET US TACKLE #5
WITH THE LAPLACE
METHOD!**



Much Easier

5. $te^{at} u(t) * e^{bt} u(t) = \frac{e^{bt} - e^{at} + (a-b)te^{at}}{(a-b)^2} u(t),$
 $a \neq b$

$$\mathcal{L}[te^{at}u(t)] = \frac{1}{(s-a)^2} \quad \mathcal{L}[e^{bt}u(t)] = \frac{1}{s-b} \quad \Rightarrow \mathcal{L}[y(t)] = \frac{1}{(s-a)^2(s-b)}$$

$$\frac{1}{(s-a)^2(s-b)} = \frac{1}{(a-b)(s-a)^2} - \frac{1}{(a-b)^2(s-a)} + \frac{1}{(a-b)^2(s-b)}$$

**PARTIAL
FRACTION
EXPANSION**

$$\Rightarrow y(t) = \frac{1}{(a-b)} te^{at} u(t) - \frac{1}{(a-b)^2} e^{at} u(t) + \frac{1}{(a-b)^2} e^{bt} u(t)$$

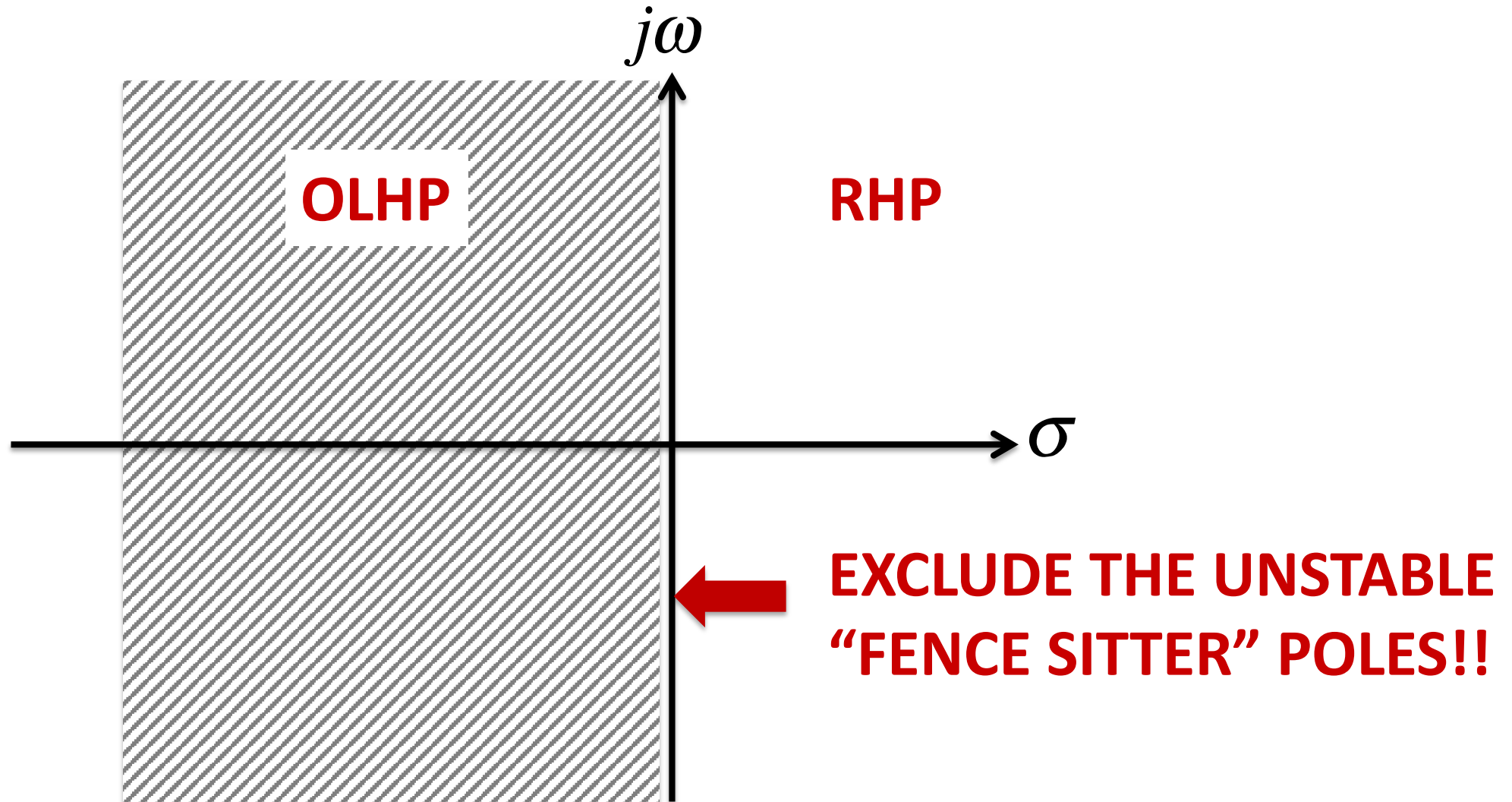
$$= \frac{e^{bt} - e^{at} + (a-b)te^{at}}{(a-b)^2} u(t) \quad a \neq b$$





Recap: The Open Left Half Plane

The Open Left Half Plane (OLHP) extends from 0- to negative infinity





Interpreting Pole Locations

- A real pole to the left of the vertical axis yields a term with a stable response
- A real pole at the origin yields a term with a ramp response to a step input
- A real pole to the right of the vertical axis is associated with an unstable growing response
- A complex conjugate pair of poles is associated with an oscillatory response
 - When the real part is negative, it is a decaying oscillatory response
 - When the real part is positive, it is a growing oscillatory response
 - When the real part is 0, it is a non-decaying oscillation



Unstable System Example

$$H(s) = 1 + s$$

$$\Rightarrow Y(s) = X(s) + sX(s) \quad y(t) = x(t) + \frac{dx(t)}{dt}$$

$$x(t) = \underbrace{x_s(t)}_{\text{SIGNAL}} + \underbrace{x_n(t)}_{\text{NOISE}}$$

$$x_s(t) = 10 \sin(1000t)u(t)$$

$$x_n(t) = \frac{1}{100} \sin(10^7 t)u(t)$$

THE NOISE SIGNAL HAS A SMALLER AMPLITUDE, BUT A HIGHER FREQUENCY



Signal to Noise Ratio (SNR)

$$x_s(t) = 10 \sin(1000t)u(t)$$

$$x_n(t) = \frac{1}{100} \sin(10^7 t)u(t)$$

POWER:

$$P_s = \frac{1}{2} (10)^2 = 50$$

$$P_n = \frac{1}{2} (10^{-2})^2 = 5 \times 10^{-5}$$

POWER RATIO:

$$SNR = \frac{P_s}{P_n} = 10^6$$

**REASONABLY CLEAN INPUT
HIGH FREQUENCY NOISE**



The Output

$$\mathbf{Y(s)} = \mathbf{X(s)} + \mathbf{sX(s)} \quad y(t) = x(t) + \frac{dx(t)}{dt}$$

$$y(t) = x_s(t) + x_n(t) + \frac{d}{dt} \{x_s(t) + x_n(t)\}$$

$$= 10 \sin(10^3 t) + 10^{-2} \sin(10^7 t) + 10^4 \cos(10^3 t) + 10^5 \cos(10^7 t)$$



$$P_s(@\text{output}) = \frac{1}{2}(10^4)^2 + \frac{1}{2}(10)^2 \approx 5 \times 10^7$$

$$P_n(@\text{output}) = \frac{1}{2}(10^5)^2 + \frac{1}{2}(10^{-2})^2 \approx 5 \times 10^9$$

$$SNR = \frac{P_s}{P_n} = 10^{-2}$$

YIKES!!

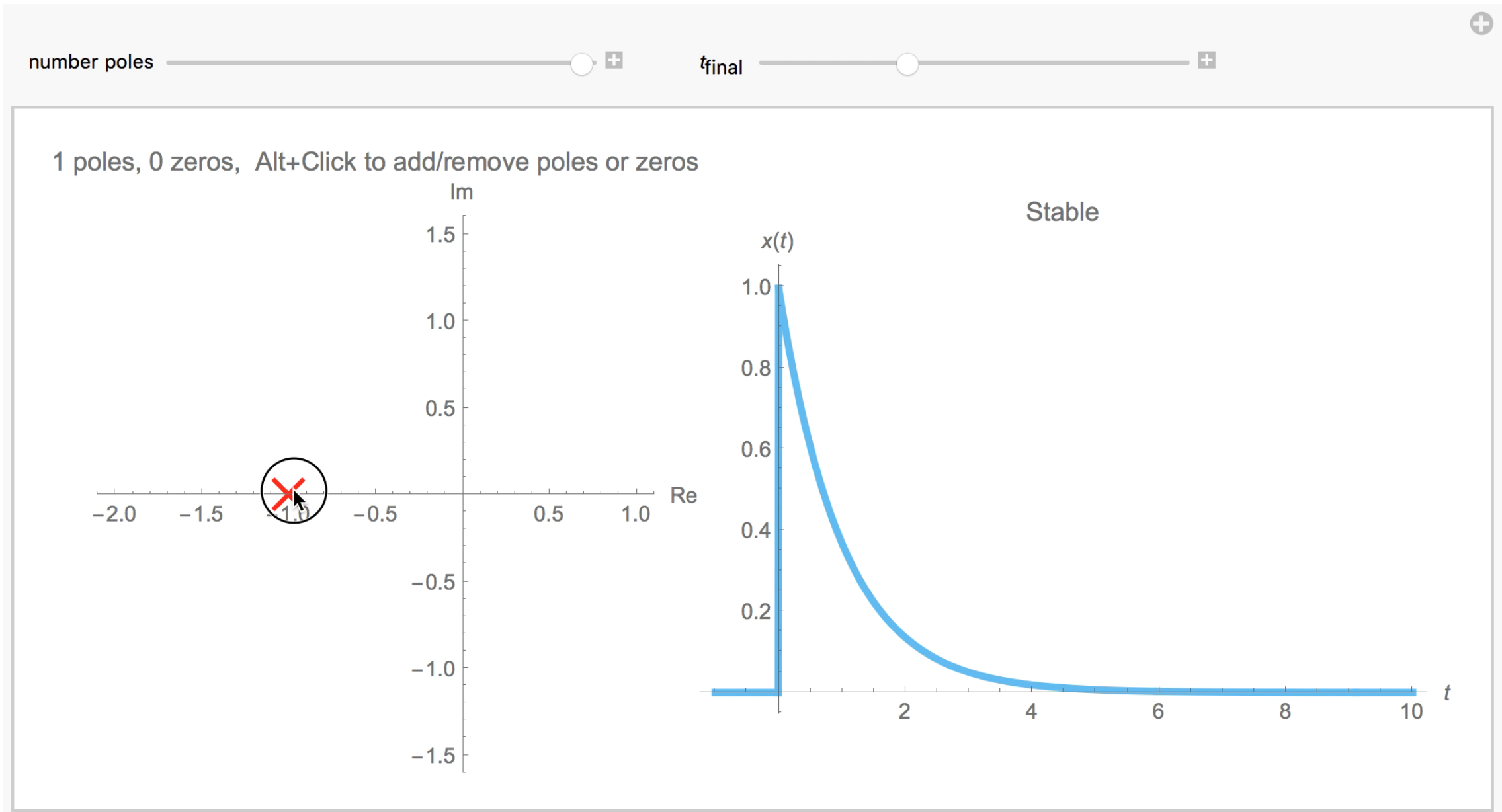


What Zeros Tell Us

- Zeros do not have any impact on stability, only poles do
- However, zeros affect the coefficients of the partial fraction expansion, and thereby affect the influence of the poles
- We will learn a bit later that zeros on the right half plane are problematic for a reason that is unrelated to stability
 - They produce undesirable non-minimum phase systems that can be confusing to control



Poles and Zeros – The Movie





Repeated Poles

Table 3-3: Transform pairs for four types of poles.

Pole	$\mathbf{X(s)}$	$x(t)$
1. Distinct real	$\frac{A}{s+a}$	$Ae^{-at} u(t)$
2. Repeated real	$\frac{A}{(s+a)^n}$	$\Rightarrow A \frac{t^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} e^{-at} u(t)$
3. Distinct complex	$\left[\frac{Ae^{j\theta}}{s+a+jb} + \frac{Ae^{-j\theta}}{s+a-jb} \right]$	$2Ae^{-at} \cos(bt - \theta) u(t)$
4. Repeated complex	$\left[\frac{Ae^{j\theta}}{(s+a+jb)^n} + \frac{Ae^{-j\theta}}{(s+a-jb)^n} \right]$	$\frac{2At^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} e^{-at} \cos(bt - \theta) u(t)$

REPEATED POLES CORRESPOND TO “RAMP LIKE” FACTORS IN THE TIME DOMAIN



System Stability Revisited

We are now ready to take a more general look at system stability

$$\mathbf{X}(s) = \frac{\mathbf{N}(s)}{\mathbf{D}(s)} = C \frac{(s - z_1)(s - z_2) \dots (s - z_m)}{(s - p_1)(s - p_2) \dots (s - p_n)}$$

As with partial fractions, it makes sense to study the answers for strictly proper ($m < n$), proper ($m = n$), and improper functions ($m > n$) separately



Stability Definition

Bounded Input Bounded Output (BIBO)

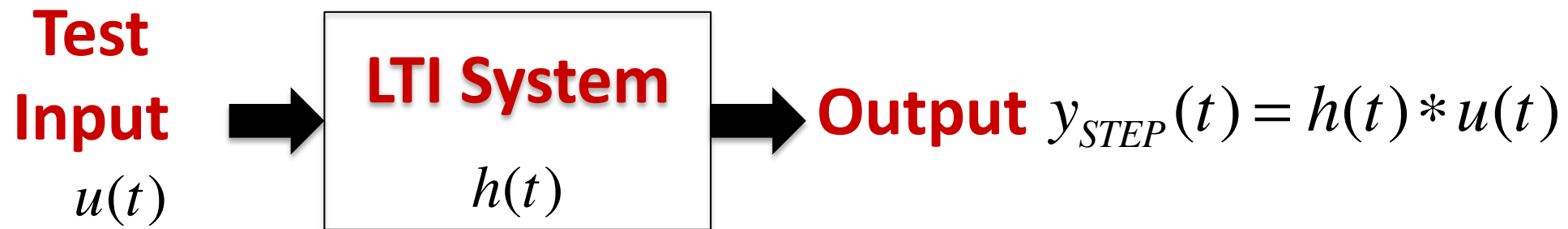
- If the input is bounded (i.e., finite), then the output will be bounded as well
- This should be true for every bounded input (even a single exception is not possible)
- LTI systems for which this is true are said to be BIBO Stable

For a BIBO system, the impulse response should be absolutely integrable:

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |h(t)| dt \text{ is finite}$$



Practical Stability Testing



The unit step function is a commonly preferred input for stability testing

- It is bounded (max = 1)
- It has infinite energy
- It is mathematically simple
- It is easy to generate in the laboratory (flip a switch ON)



Strictly Proper Case ($m < n$)

Again, it is best to learn from examples

$$\mathbf{H}(s) = \frac{s^2 - 4s + 3}{s(s+1)(s+3)} = \frac{1}{s} - \frac{4}{s+1} + \frac{4}{s+3}$$

$$\Rightarrow h(t) = [1 - 4e^{-t} + 4e^{-3t}]u(t)$$

- Poles at 0, -1, and -3
- Let's apply our favorite bounded input, the unit step function, and see what happens:

$$y_{STEP}(t) = h(t) * u(t)$$



Strictly Proper Case ($m < n$)

$$\mathcal{L}[u(t)] = \frac{1}{s}$$

$$\mathbf{H}(s) = \frac{s^2 - 4s + 3}{s(s+1)(s+3)} = \frac{1}{s} - \frac{4}{s+1} + \frac{4}{s+3}$$

$$\mathbf{Y}(s) = \frac{1}{\underline{s^2}} - \frac{4}{s(s+1)} + \frac{4}{s(s+3)}$$

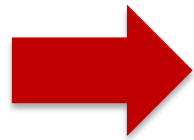
Even before completing the partial fraction expansions, we see right away that the first term is problematic, since it corresponds to a ramp that grows indefinitely !!



In the Time Domain: Table 2-2

Table 2-2: Commonly encountered convolutions.

1. $u(t) * u(t) = t u(t)$



2. $e^{at} u(t) * u(t) = \left(\frac{e^{at} - 1}{a} \right) u(t)$

3. $e^{at} u(t) * e^{bt} u(t) = \left[\frac{e^{at} - e^{bt}}{a - b} \right] u(t), \quad a \neq b$

4. $e^{at} u(t) * e^{at} u(t) = t e^{at} u(t)$

5. $t e^{at} u(t) * e^{bt} u(t) = \frac{e^{bt} - e^{at} + (a - b) t e^{at}}{(a - b)^2} u(t),$
 $a \neq b$

6. $t e^{at} u(t) * e^{at} u(t) = \frac{1}{2} t^2 e^{at} u(t)$

7. $\delta(t - T_1) * \delta(t - T_2) = \delta(t - T_1 - T_2)$



Strictly Proper Case ($m < n$)

We put Table 2-2 to use

$$\begin{aligned} y_{STEP}(t) &= [1 - 4e^{-t} + 4e^{-3t}]u(t) * u(t) \\ &= u(t) * u(t) - 4[e^{-t}u(t)] * u(t) + 4[e^{-3t}u(t)] * u(t) \\ &= \underline{tu(t)} - 4 \frac{(e^{-t} - 1)}{(-1)}u(t) + 4 \frac{(e^{-3t} - 1)}{(-3)}u(t) \end{aligned}$$

- The underlined ramp term grows indefinitely as t increases, so **NOT BIBO STABLE !**
- The problematic term was the pole at 0



Proper Case ($m = n$)

Example:

$$\mathbf{H(s)} = \frac{2s^2 + 10s + 6}{s^2 + 5s + 6} = 2 - \frac{6}{s + 2} + \frac{6}{s + 3}$$

- We already know that the second and third terms lead to (unproblematic) damped responses, so let's examine the constant term.
- The step response is just a finite constant (safe)

Basically, the proper case is no different from the strictly proper case, i.e., poles need to be in the Open LHP for BIBO stability



Improper Case ($m > n$)

Example:

$$\mathbf{H(s)} = \frac{6s^3 + 4s^2 + 8s + 6}{s^2 + 2s + 1} = \underline{6s} - 8 + \frac{18s + 14}{(s + 1)^2}$$

The potentially problematic term is the first one ($6s$), so let's see what happens when we apply a step input ($1/s$). The output is:

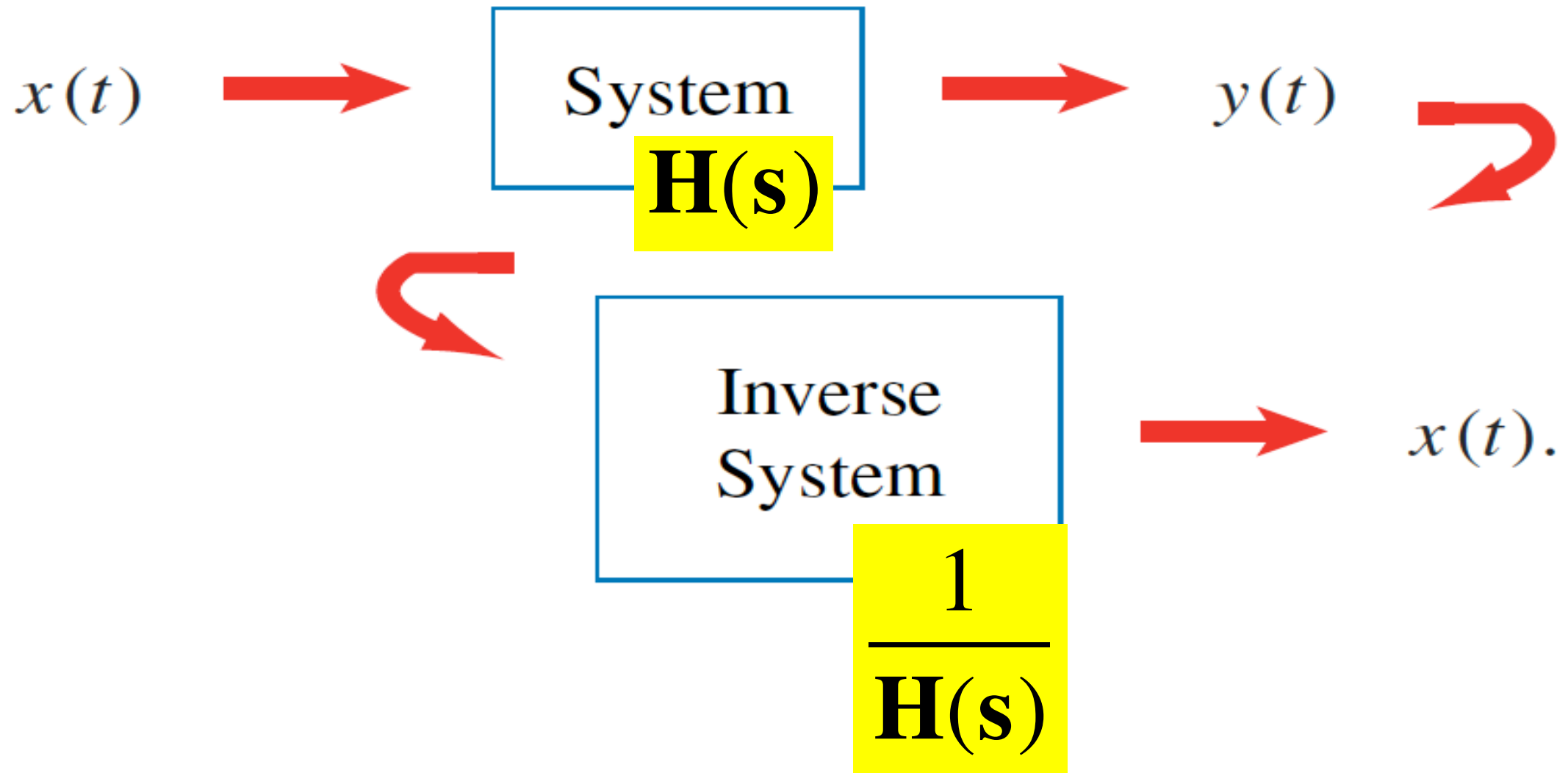
$$y(t) = \mathcal{L}^{-1} \left[6s \cdot \frac{1}{s} \right] = 6 \delta(t) \text{ **INFINITE**}$$

Improper transfer functions are always BIBO unstable, regardless of the locations of their poles and zeros



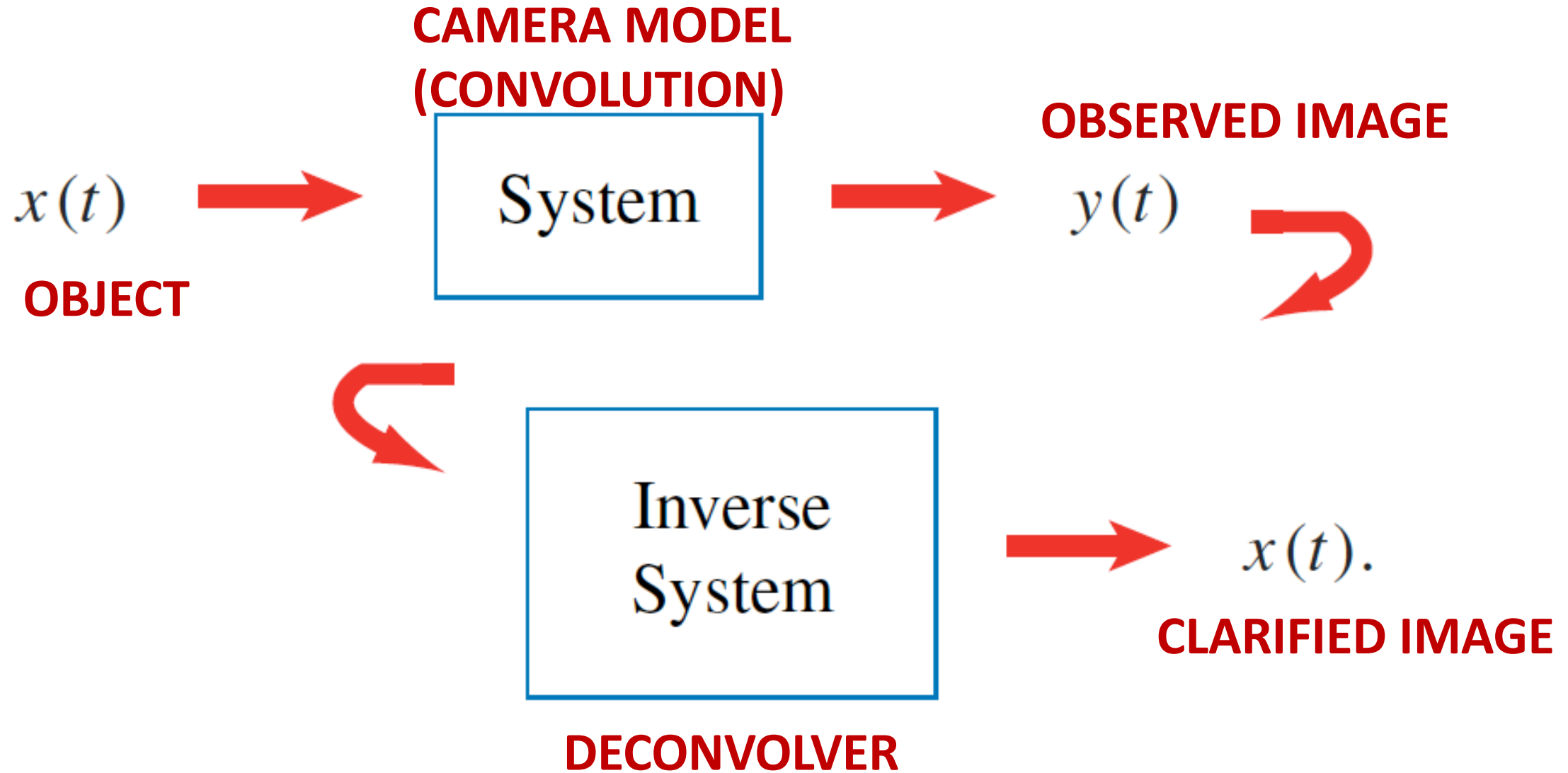
Invertible Systems

Mathematically, the inverse system is easy to write down:



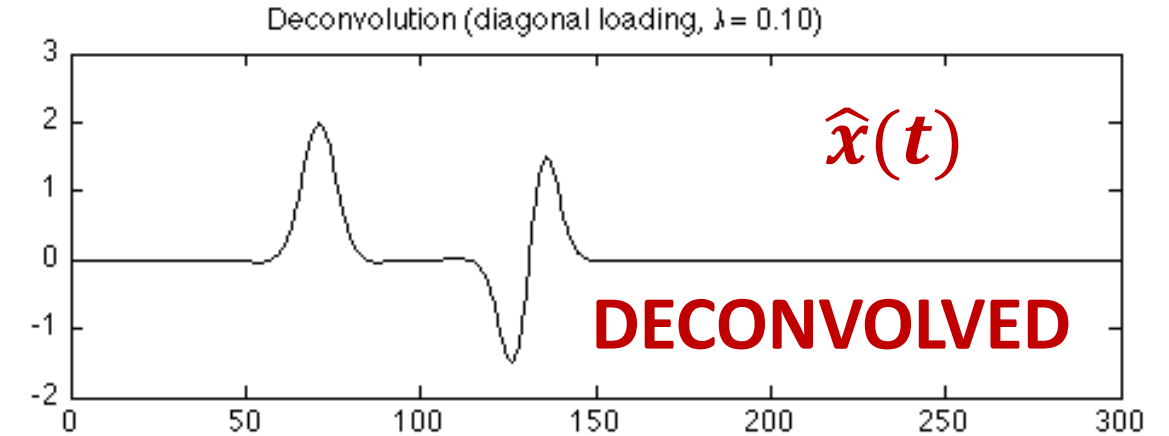
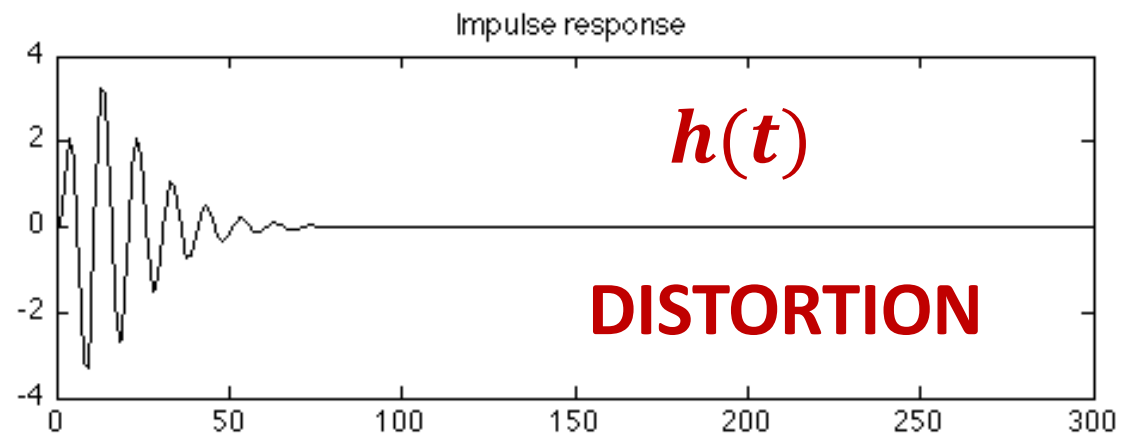
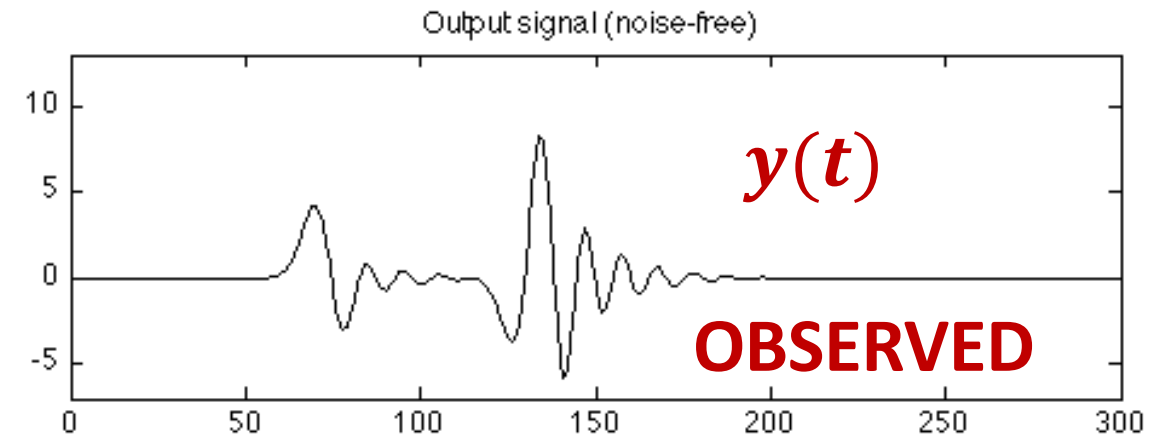
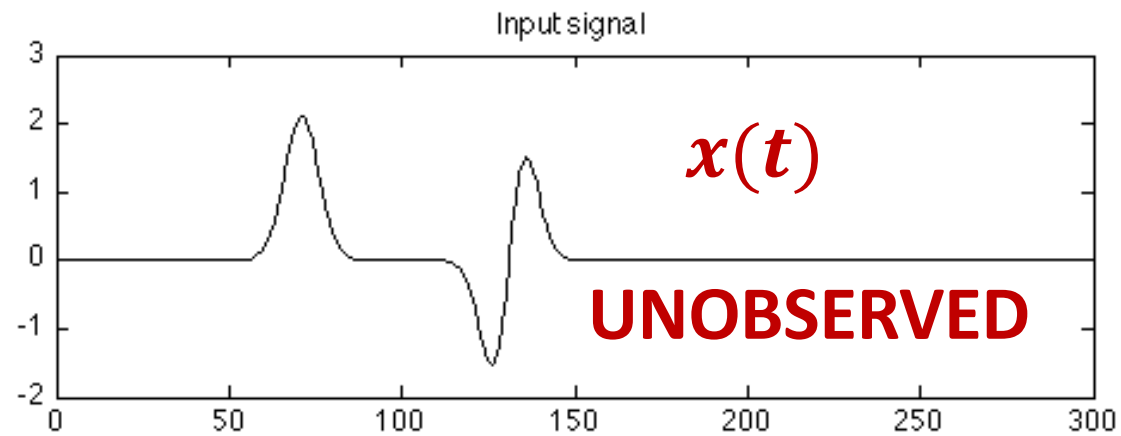


Deconvolution





1-D Signal Example





Example: Deconvolution in Astronomy

CAPTURED IMAGE



DECONVOLVED IMAGE

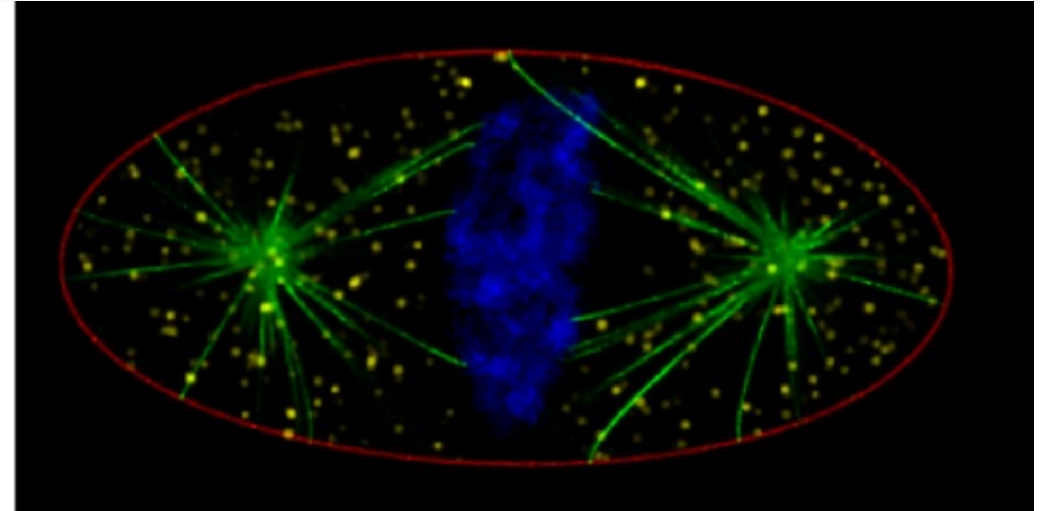
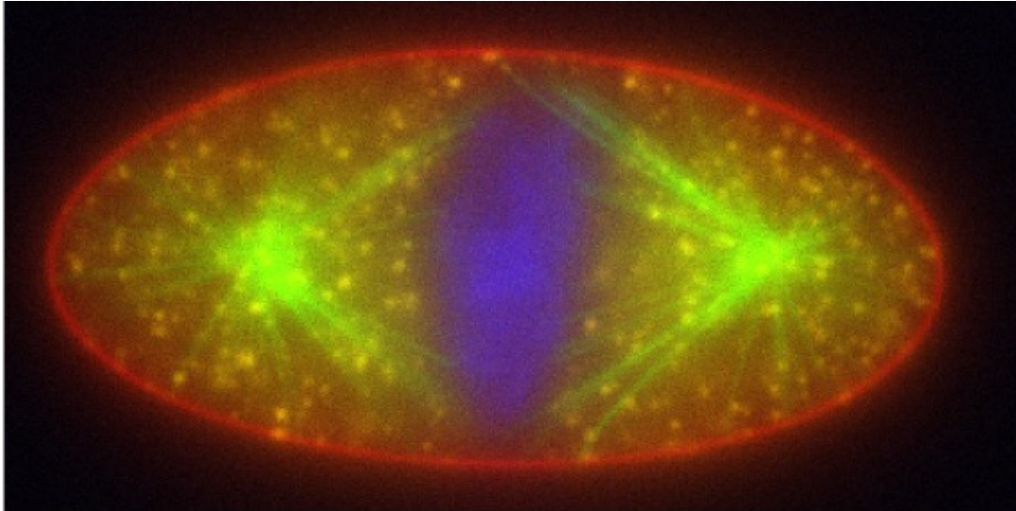


http://biomedia4n6.uniroma3.it/research/blind_deconvolution.html

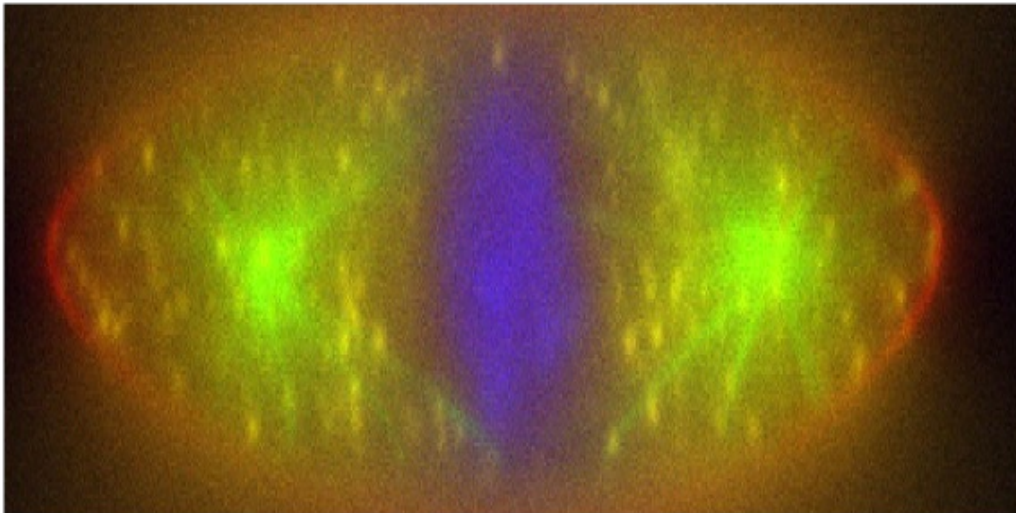


Deconvolution in Microscopy

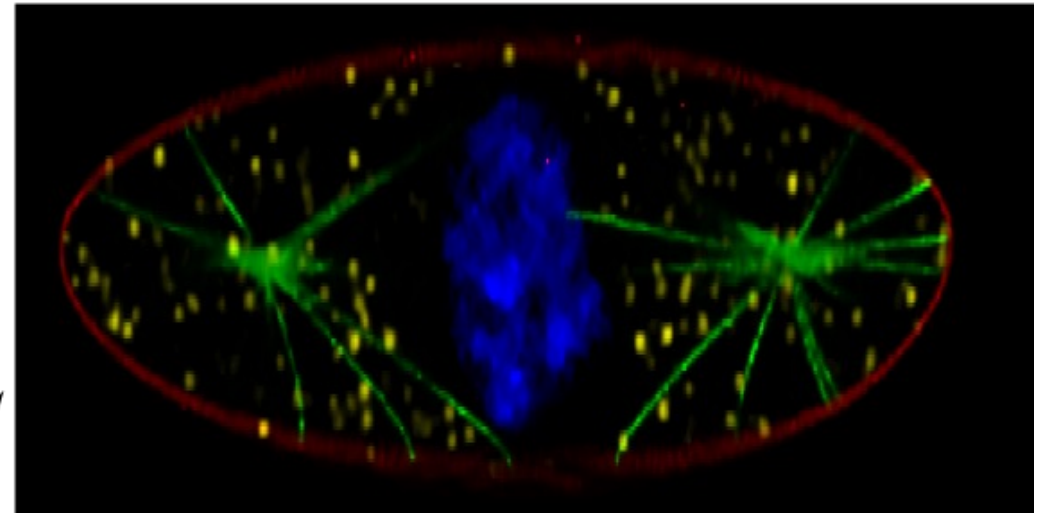
Lateral section



axial section



optical axis



Data

Deconvolution

https://cral-perso.univ-lyon1.fr/labo/perso/ferreol.soulez/coupesResultat_en.png



So, what's the catch?

The inverse system must be well behaved

$$\frac{1}{H(s)}$$

The poles and zeros of the System and the Inverse system are swapped, so the Inverse System may or may not be well behaved

- It may not be stable
- It may not be causal



Opportunity

$$\frac{1}{H(s)}$$

Interestingly, the majority of deconvolution applications have challenging transfer functions, and added noise

- We also have to contend with noise and signal distortions that may be non-linear**
- A rich area for signal processing research: Opportunity to invent custom deconvolution algorithms for applications**



Theorem

► A BIBO stable and causal LTI system has a BIBO stable and causal inverse system if and only if all of its poles and zeros are in the open left half-plane, and they are equal in number (its transfer function is proper). Such a system is called a *minimum phase* system. ◀

MINIMUM PHASE SYSTEMS BECOME IMPORTANT WHEN DESIGNING CONTROL SYSTEMS.

NON-MINIMUM PHASE SYSTEMS ARE TRICKY TO CONTROL



Example

**DOES THE FOLLOWING SYSTEM MEET THE CRITERIA FOR INVERTIBILITY?
IF SO, DERIVE THE INVERSE SYSTEM IN THE SAME FORMAT**

$$h(t) = \delta(t) + 2e^{-3t}u(t) - 6e^{-4t}u(t)$$

STEP 1: Write down the transfer function:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{H(s)} &= 1 + \frac{2}{s+3} - \frac{6}{s+4} \\ &= \frac{(s+1)(s+2)}{(s+3)(s+4)} \end{aligned}$$



Example (contd.)

STEP 2: Analyze the zeros and poles

- ✓ $H(s)$ is proper ($m = n = 2$)
- ✓ Zeros at $\{-1, -2\}$, both in the open left-half plane
- ✓ Poles at $\{-3, -4\}$, both in the open left-half plane

Therefore, the inverse exists, and $H(s)$ is a minimum phase system

STEP 4: Derive the inverse system

$$\mathbf{G}(s) = \frac{1}{\mathbf{H}(s)} = \frac{(s+3)(s+4)}{(s+1)(s+2)}$$

$$g(t) = \delta(t) + 6e^{-t}u(t) - 2e^{-2t}u(t)$$



Non-minimum Phase Systems

Let's tweak the system and add a zero to the right half plane
(the poles remain the same)

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{H}_{NEW}(s) &= \frac{(s+1)(s+2)(1-s)}{(s+3)(s+4)} \\ &= \mathbf{H}(s) - s\mathbf{H}(s) \end{aligned}$$

$$h_{NEW}(t) = h(t) \underset{\uparrow}{-} \frac{dh(t)}{dt}$$

ASSUME ZERO
INITIAL
CONDITION

NON-MINIMUM PHASE SYSTEMS ARE CONFUSING TO CONTROL

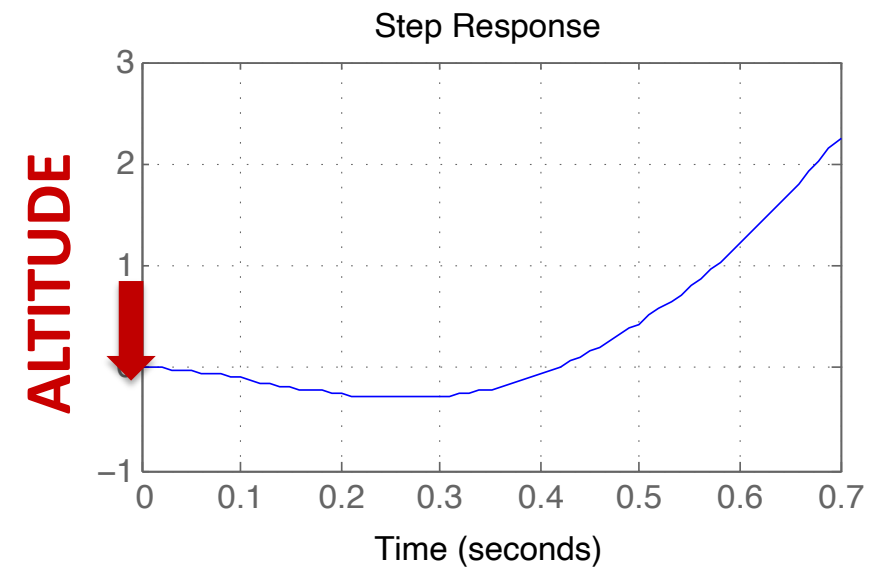
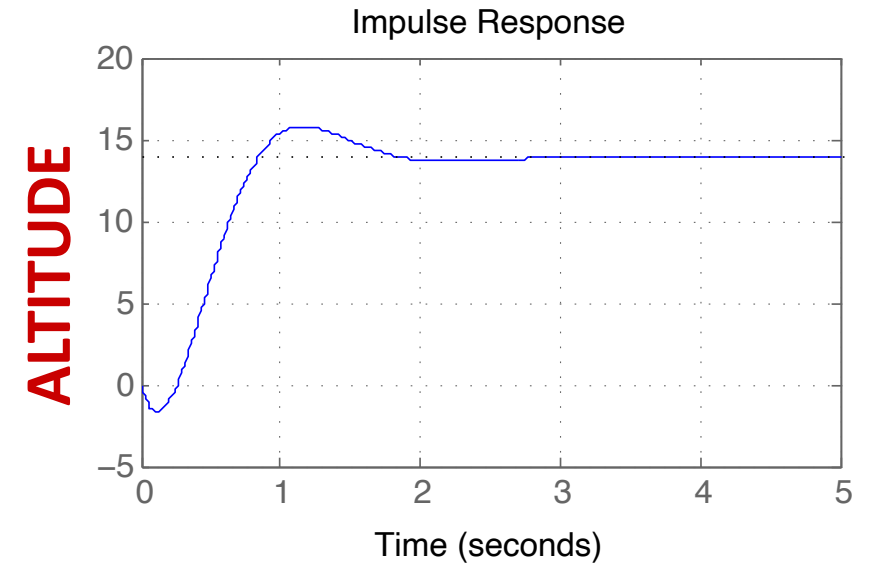
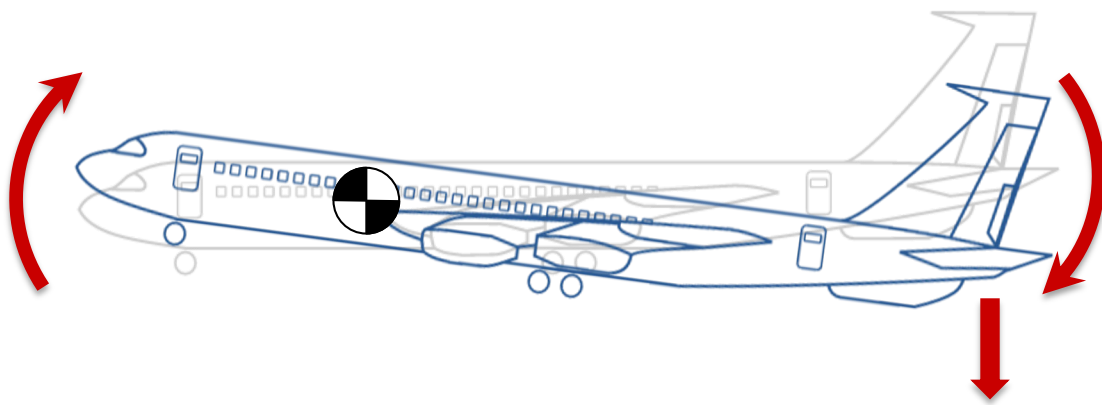


Airplane Control

$$H(s) = \frac{Y(s)}{E(s)} = \frac{30(s - 6)}{s(s^2 + 4s + 13)}$$

$Y(s)$: Altitude

$E(s)$: Elevon Deflection





Airplane Canards

Some fighter airplanes have canards to suppress non-minimum phase behavior





Other Real-life Examples

- **Bicycles:** To turn a bike left, you need to lean slightly right initially
- **Parallel parking a car close to the curb:** The transfer function from steering angle to distance from the curb is non-minimum phase.
- **Airplanes:** The transfer function from elevon to altitude is non-minimum phase. When the elevon is raised there is a force that pushes the rear of the airplane down. This causes a rotation which gives an increase of the angle of attack and an increase of the lift. **Initially the aircraft will lose altitude (confusing).** *The Wright brothers understood this weird effect and added control surfaces in the front of the aircraft to suppress it.*
- **Balancing a stick on your finger and trying to move it:** You need to move it backwards initially
- **Hoverboards and Segways:** To move forward, you may need to lean backwards initially



Quick Take

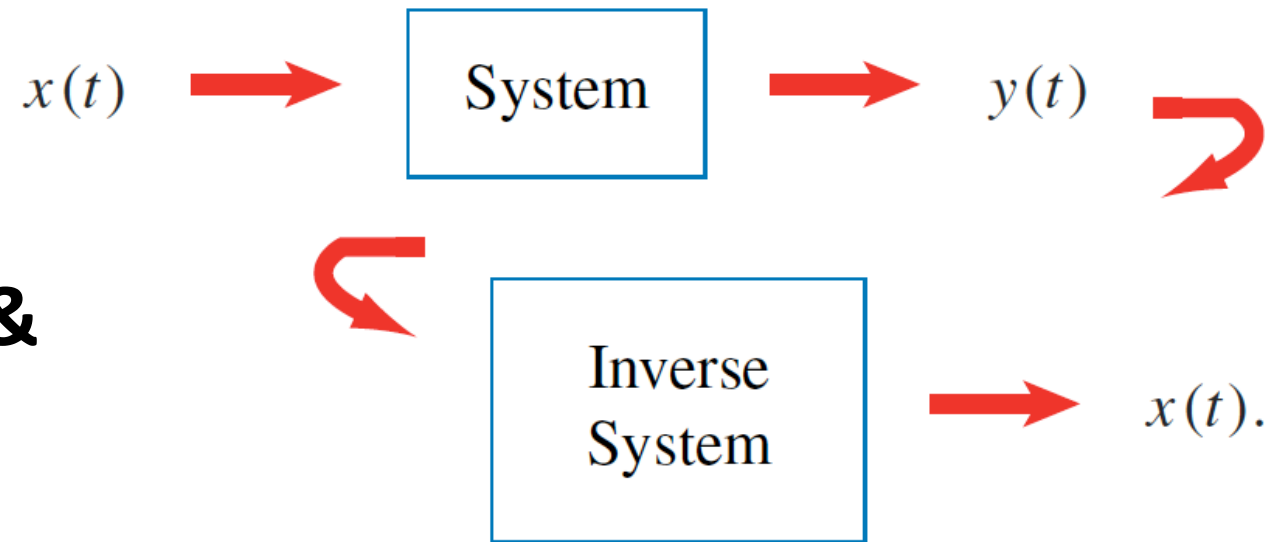
- **The presence of complex conjugate pole pairs indicates an oscillatory nature of the system**
 - Left of the vertical axis $\Rightarrow$ dying oscillation
 - On the vertical axis $\Rightarrow$ stable oscillation
 - Right of the vertical axis $\Rightarrow$ growing oscillation
- **Improper transfer functions are always BIBO unstable, no further analysis is needed!**
- **Proper and strictly proper transfer functions are BIBO stable if all the poles are in the open left-half plane**
- **Proper systems are minimum phase if all poles and zeros are in the open Left half plane, and equal in number**



Summary

The structure of the transfer function tells us a lot about its stability

- Locations and poles and zeros
- We looked at inverse systems & minimum phase systems
- The structure of the Laplace transform for the inverse system tells us a lot about its properties





For the Next Class

- Work through the textbook examples in Sections 3.6 – 3.8
- Study Sections 3.10-3.11 (we are skipping Section 3-9 of the textbook)

How to Study:

1. Read the assigned sections in order to understand the basic concepts, and aim to memorize the concepts
2. Attempt the in-chapter exercises and practice until you can do them fully on your own without notes, like in a test
3. Write down your questions and bring them to class